

Making an old working drive usable, faulty hotkeys and more...

We take a look at some nagging issues and help resolve them

Salvaging old drive

I had an old desktop (bought around 2004). It stopped working and after a few attempts at getting it to work, I bought a Lenovo laptop. While I was browsing the web, I came across an article which said that I could use my internal hard drive as an external one after some modifications. I would like to use my PC's hard drive which is lying useless. I have already detached it.

Neel Thakur

A You can use your internal drive as a secondary storage drive. You will need a SATA to USB adapter to do that. Since it is a 3.5-inch internal drive, you will require an adapter which also has an external power port. Seagate GoFlex Desk adapters allow you to connect any 3.5-inch drive and use it as an external



SATA to USB adapter

drive. Here is one: <http://goo.gl/8tsMC>
You can also get alternatives at any shop which sells PC components. These options (one of which is shown above) might even turn out to be more economical than the Seagate adapter.

Gaming woes

Hello Team Digit. I am a little worried about the battery life of my laptop. I purchased it 5 months ago. I play Mass Effect 3 on 800x600 resolution because it

crashes as soon as I switch to full HD.

My question is, does playing such high-end games for long hours degrade battery life, specially when the laptop is connected to an AC adapter?

My Laptop configs are:

- Make: Sony VAIO VPCCB45FN
- Processor: Inte Core i5-2450m 2.50 GHz
- RAM: 4 GB DDR3
- Operating System: Windows 7 Home Premium (64-bit)
- Hard Drive: 640 GB
- Internal Graphics: AMD Radeon HD 6630

Yash Kher

A Keep a tab on the system temperatures when you are playing games. If the temperatures cross 60 degrees, then it is advisable to remove the fully charged battery from the laptop if you are using the AC mains supply. Excessive heating rather than excessive gaming, can affect your laptop's battery. If you don't want to remove the battery, then it is best for you to invest in a laptop cooler, which will help keep the laptop temperatures low.

Laptop issues

I am a regular reader of Digit and like it very much. It gives me great pleasure while reading the magazine and the reviews. I recently bought a Dell Inspiron 15R Special Edition with following specifications:

- Processor: Intel Core i7-3612QM
- RAM: 4 GB RAM
- Hard Disk: 1 TB HDD
- Internal Graphics: HD 7730M

I am experiencing following issues:

1. Out of the 4 rubber contacts beneath the laptop, one of the contact does not touch the flat table and touches the table when I apply pressure. Is it a



Cooler master Notepal U

manufacturing defect? Should I be concerned about it and ask Dell customer care for replacement?

2. Another problem is that the computer tends to slow down drastically when I run custom or full scan using McAfee as it should not happen seeing a i7 processor on board. Please tell is it common issue or a software/hardware problem because in other cases (when scan is not running) the laptop is very smooth.

Karan Ghai

A Let's look at each issue:

1. If you claim that your table is completely horizontal and still the rubber feet aren't making contact, then you can take your laptop to your nearest Dell service centre and ask them to check the issue, they will most likely replace the faulty rubber foot with a correct one. If you do not want to visit the service centre, then one way you can get rid of the problem is by attaching a flat folded piece of paper using a cellotape, so that it is in line with the other feet.
2. You will have to check your Task Manager to see if you have anything else running in the background while you are doing a full system scan via your security suite. System